

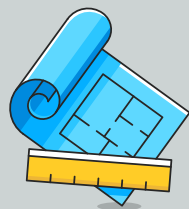
S U N D A Y

PUTTING FIRST THINGS FIRST *Blueprint*

SCRIPTURE TEXT:

**“You shall love the Lord your God with all your heart,
with all your soul, and with all your strength.”**

Deuteronomy 6: 5 (NKJV)



LESSON OBJECTIVE

What do you think of when you hear build, design, or create? Can you name things you or someone else made, designed, or created? Maybe a dollhouse, a model car, a gazebo, or even a house. What about this universe? The Bible tells us in Genesis 1:1, “In the beginning, God created the heavens and the earth.”

Our world is God’s intentional design and creation. God had a plan, a divine blueprint. A blueprint is a detailed plan used by every builder to construct a house or other structure. It provides all the drawings and clear instructions on where everything should go and how it should be done. God purposefully designed and built every aspect of the universe; He created something from nothing during the seven days of creation. No part of God’s creation resulted from a random chance or coincidence. We worship God because He is our Creator, and He wants to be in a relationship with us. We are important to Him, and if He is important to us, we should put Him first in everything we do every day.

“In the beginning, God created the heavens and the earth.” Genesis 1:1



God is the Designer and Creator of all things.

Read Genesis 1:1 – 2:7

The Bible tells us that in the beginning, God had a plan, a “divine blueprint” that was first established in His mind and His heart. He laid out a precise sequence or order during Creation week, a literal week of seven days. On day one, there was day and night (Gen. 3-5). On day two, He divided the earth from the seas (Gen. 1:6-8). On day three, God called forth the vegetation, grass, herbs that yielded seeds, and fruit trees, all needed for human beings to sustain life (Gen. 1:9-13).

On day four, God created the sun, the moon, and the stars, “God set them in the firmament of the heavens to give light on the earth, and to rule over the day and over the night, and to divide the light from darkness” (Gen. 1: 14-19). On day five, God created all kinds of fish for the sea and created every type of winged bird to fly in the sky (Gen.1: 20-23). On day six, God created animals, and then He created human beings in His own image (Gen. 1: 24-31. On day 7, God rested and blessed and made holy the seventh day, the Sabbath. Scientists—astronomers, biologists, geologists, physicians and physicists continue to be baffled by the intricate and detailed creativity—all made by the hand of God.

Our universe was designed and created by the Creator God who **purposefully** built a majestic creation and culminated his creation with human beings. We are made in his image;

to be like Him in character and purpose. God wants to be in a relationship with us. We should feel grateful to worship Him as we think about how great and awesome God is. We were made to worship God, and He should always take center stage in our homes and in our family relationships.

Families today have many competing commitments. However, the most important things to your family should never be squeezed out by those things that matter less. Only your family can decide those priorities; ask one another if you want to live by your values or other outside pressures and demands. If you say you love the Lord and want to be in a relationship with Him, then determine to make Him a priority in your family life. Make a commitment today to put **family worship** in the schedule first.

PRAYER

Dear God, You are our Creator, and for this reason we worship You. We thank You for making us in Your image and for Your love, mercy, and grace. Help us to put You first in our lives and to follow the blueprint in Your Word. We love You with all our heart, and soul and strength. In Jesus' name, amen.



APPLY IT & LIVE IT



BIBLE CHALLENGE

Practice the memory verse together as a family. You can create a song using the bible verse or any memory device that will help you memorize it.



REBUILDING THE FAMILY ALTAR

CREATE A FAMILY MISSION STATEMENT FOR YOUR FAMILY

1. Gather your family together and write down the answers to these questions: **Have everyone get involved** in answering the questions. Make sure to look out for the quiet ones and encourage them to share. The process is equally as crucial as the result. During this process, you may learn new things about one another and find new ways to affirm and validate every family member.

- *How will we treat each other?*
- *What traits do we want to represent our family (you can include the fruit of the spirit)?*
- *What things do we not want in our family?*
- *What kind of home do we want to invite our friends to?*
- *How can we encourage growth and self-esteem in each family member?*
- *How can we deepen our faith and have a closer relationship with Jesus?*
- *How will we include family worship into our busy schedules?*
When will we do it? What will it look like in our family?

2. Optional: Creating a vision board is an excellent step to add to this process. If you have the materials, you can look for magazine pictures, family pictures, stickers, and markers and create a board that represents who your family is with icons that show the individuality of every family member. You may do your vision board online; however, since everyone

FAMILY TALK

- How has God demonstrated that He values us and loves us?
- How can we demonstrate that we love God? Share one way in which you can show that you value and respect your fellow human beings.
- Share one way in which you can value and respect one another in the family. Choose one family member to whom you will give extra love and respect today. Choose one person outside of your family that you can show extra kindness today.

is spending a lot of time online (Zoom meetings, social media, etc.), using tangible materials will make it a kinesthetic activity, getting everyone involved.

3. Now, **put everyone's ideas together** and write a statement that summarizes who you are or want to be as a family. It can be a song, a poem, a phrase, or even a single word. Remember the process is as important as the outcome. So, take the time and get everyone involved. This statement should inspire you and serve as a GPS to keep your family on track, especially during turbulent times.

4. Write, type, or draw your family mission statement. Frame it and put it somewhere everyone can see it. **Read it every day.** Give every family member their own copy.

Explore the uniqueness of your family

Write it, draw it, frame it

Live it daily